

Delhi Sultanate: Slave Dynasty

1. Who was the first ruler of the Slave Dynasty?

- (a) Iltutmish
- (b) Qutbuddin Aibak
- (c) Raziyya
- (d) Balban

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The first ruler of the Slave Dynasty (or named Gulam Dynasty) was Qutb-ud-Din Aibak who ruled from 1206 to 1210 A.D. He established his capital at Lahore. Though he was ugly in appearance, he was intelligent and impressive in behaviour. He was taken as a prisoner and sold to the Qazi of Nishapur named Fakhruddin as a slave in his childhood. He was taken care and provided with proper education and military training by the kind-hearted Qazi but soon after the death of the Qazi, his sons sold Aibak to Muhammad Ghori. He was well versed in Islamic theology, horse riding and swordsmanship. Owing to his skill and qualities, he soon attracted the attention of his master and was appointed commander of a troop. Shortly afterwards battles; he was promoted to the post of Amir-i- Akhur, the master of the royal stable. When Ghori invaded India, Aibak came with his master and provided him his active support during battles. The successes of his master by and large depended on his military skill. Ghori was immensely pleased with him, and he appointed him his governor of the Indian empire. In 1206 A.D., on his way to Ghazni, Ghori died. His empire was inherited by his slaves, as he had no son to succeed him. Aibak, who was a viceroy of his Indian Empire was invited by the Amirs of Lahore to assume the powers. He bestowed the title of Malik and Sipahsalar on himself. Muhammad Ghori had no male successor to inherit his empire; hence his nephew, Ghiyasuddin Mahmud ascended the throne of Ghori after his death in 1206 A.D.

2. "His theory of kingship was based on the principles of prestige, power and justice." Who said these words about Balban?

- (a) A. B. M. Habibullah
- (b) Zia-ud-din Barani
- (c) Stanley Lane-Poole
- (d) R. P. Tripathi
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (b)

Zia-ud-din Barani said about Balban "His theory of kingship was based on the principles of prestige, power and justice." It is noteworthy that Balban was a ruler of the Delhi Sultanate during the Mamluk dynasty (also known as the slave dyansty). He adopted the policy of 'blood and Iron'.

3. Which Sultan of Delhi Sultanate was known as 'Lakh Baksh'?

- (a) Qutub-ud-din Aibak
- (b) Balban
- (c) Raziya
- (d) Alauddin Khalji
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (a)

Sultan Qutub-ud-din Aibak was the first Muslim ruler of India who ruled from his capital in Lahore. He was known as Lal Baksh because of his generosity.

4. The Muslim ruler whose empire was regarded as a part of Dar-ul-Islam was

- (a) Balban
- (b) Razia
- (c) Iltutmish
- (d) Nasir-ud-Din
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre)-2021

Ans. (c)

During the period of Iltutmish, in 1229 A.D. the caliph of Baghdad gave Khillat to Iltutmish. Now the Sultanate was theoretically part of Dar-ul-Islam subject to the caliph of Baghdad.

5. What is 'Adhai Din ka Jhonpra'?

- (a) Mosque
- (b) Temple
- (c) Saint's hut
- (d) Tower

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Sultan Qutb-ud-Din Aibak also called "Lakh Baksh" was the first Muslim ruler of India who ruled from his capital in Lahore. He patronized scholars such as Hasan Nizami and Fakhra-i-Mudabbir, both of whom dedicated their works to Aibak. Aibak was the first Muslim ruler who settled in India and ruled unlike the earlier Muslims, who came and only raided and plundered. Though his tenure as a ruler was only four years, and most of them were spent in dealing with the revolts of nobles like Taj-ud-Din Ildiz, Nasir-ud-Din Qubachah and a few Hindu chiefs, he established a firm administrative system. He started the construction of Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque at Delhi and Adhai Din ka Jhonpda (Ajmer). He also laid the foundation of the Qutb Minar, which was completed by his successor Iltutmish. He was known as Lakh Baksh for his generosity. He never took the title of "Sultan". but according to the question option (a) is the correct answer.

6. The capital of Qutbuddin Aibak was:

- (a) Lahore (b) Delhi
(c) Ajmer (d) Lakhnauti

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

After the death of Muhammad Ghori in 1206, his General Qutbuddin Aibak, who was in charge of Lahore and north-Indian possessions was invited by Amirs of Lahore to assume the powers of Ghori. The capital of Qutbuddin Aibak was Lahore. Taj-ud-Din Yilduz, Governor of Kirman ascended the throne of Ghazni. It seems that Muhammad Ghori desired that Qutbuddin Aibak should succeed him in India. In his brief reign of four years (1206-10 A.D.), he moved his capital to Lahore to frustrate Yilduz's ambition of annexing Punjab. He strengthened his position by matrimonial alliances with influential rival Turkish Chief. Nasiruddin Qabacha of Multan refused to accept Qutbuddin as the ruler of the Delhi Sultanate. Due to this, Aibak always stayed in Lahore and never got the chance to move to Delhi.

7. The Qutub Minar was completed by-

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Qutbuddin Aibak
(c) Ulugh Khan (d) Razia Sultan
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

The Qutub Minar was completed by the famous ruler Iltutmish.

8. Iltutmish appointed his first Subedar in Bihar to :

- (a) Aivaj (b) Nasiruddin Mahmud
(c) Alimardan (d) Malik - Jani

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

In 1225 A.D., Iltutmish defeated Hisamuddin Awaz in mountains of Rajmahal near Teliyagarhi and annexed Bihar Shareef and Barh. Awaz had accepted the subordination of Iltutmish. Iltutmish had appointed Malik-Jani as the new Subedar of Bihar.

9. Who was the first Muslim ruler to formulate the 'Theory of Kingship' similar to the 'theory of divine right of the kings'?

- (a) Aibak (b) Iltutmish
(c) Balban (d) Alauddin
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017

Ans. (c)

Balban was the first ruler to propound the 'theory of Kingship' similar to the 'theory of divine right of the kings. He said, "Sultan is representative of God on earth and his place comes after Paigambar".

10. Which Sultan of Delhi introduced the practice of Sijda?

- (a) Kutub-ud-din Aibak (b) Balban
(c) Ala-ud-din Khalji (d) Muhammad bin Tuglaq
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (b)

Balban made some rules and regulations for his court and strictly enforced them. He introduced the rituals of Sizdah (greeting lying on the ground) and Paibos (kissing the feet of the king).

11. Which Delhi Sultan is known for adopting the 'blood and iron' policy?

- (a) Iltutmish (b) Balban
(c) Ala-ud-Din Khalji (d) Muhammad bin Tughluq
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

Balban was the first ruler to propound the 'Theory of Kingship' similar to the theory of divine right of the kings. He said, "Sultan is representative of God on earth and his place comes after Paigambar". It is said that he adopted the policy of 'Blood and Iron'.

12. Who among the following introduced the Persian festival Nowruz in India?

- (a) Firuz Shah Tughlaq (b) Alauddin Khilji
(c) Balban (d) Iltutmish

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Balban introduced the rituals of Sizdah (greeting lying on the ground) and Paibos (Kissing the feet of the king) in his court. He also introduced the rituals to celebrate the Persian festival Nowruz.

13. Who was the first Muslim conqueror of Bihar?

- (a) Malik Ibrahim
(b) Iltutmish
(c) Bakhtiyar Khalji
(d) Alimardan Khalji
(e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)